

WRITING SUB-TEST - MEDICINE

Notes

Assume that today's date is 08/01/2024

You are the Surgical Registrar at St. Jude's Public Hospital

Patient Details

Name: Mr Liam Sterling

Date of Birth: 15/11/1982 (41 years old)

Patient History

- Freelance Graphic Designer
- Lives with partner and young daughter
- Amateur photographer and long-distance cyclist
- Social drinker (1-2 beers/weekend)
- Non-smoker
- Tonsillectomy (2001)
- Seasonal hay fever (managed with OTC antihistamines)
- Allergy: **PENICILLIN (Reaction: Urticarial rash)**

Family History

- Father: Osteoarthritis
- Mother: Hyperthyroidism
- Brother: Eczema

Medications

- OTC antihistamines (as required)

05/01/2024

C/O

- Sudden onset of severe, colicky RUQ pain (10 hours)
- Radiation to the right shoulder blade
- Nausea and bilious vomiting (x1) post-spicy meal

Examination

- Tenderness in the RUQ

- Positive Murphy's Sign
- Temperature: 38.3°C; Pulse: 95 bpm; Blood Pressure: 130/80 mmHg

Investigations

- Ultrasound: Thickened gallbladder wall (5mm), pericholecystic fluid, and multiple mobile gallstones.

06/01/2024

Laparoscopic cholecystectomy (uncomplicated)

C/O

- Post-operative pain (5/10)
- Mild sore throat
- Anxiety regarding a scheduled photography workshop

Examination

- Surgery uncomplicated
- Stable vitals; lungs clear

Plan

- Commence oral fluids
- Encourage mobilization with assistance

08/01/2024

C/O

- "Itchy and tight" feeling at the umbilical site

Examination

- Umbilical port: Erythema, localized swelling, and clear discharge
- Other port sites: Healing well
- Abdomen: Soft but slightly bloated
- Temperature: 37.5°C; Pulse: 82 bpm; Blood Pressure: 128/82 mmHg

Diagnosis

- Superficial Surgical Site Infection (SSI)

Management

- Diagnosis explained to patient
- Prescribed Clindamycin 300mg QID for 7 days (Alternative due to Penicillin allergy)
- Wound dressed

Plan

- Discharge today
- Refer to GP (Dr Sarah Jenkins) for definitive wound management and removal of non-dissolvable sutures in 5 days
- Advised to avoid heavy lifting and long-distance cycling for 6 weeks

Writing Task

"Using the information given in the case notes, write a letter of discharge to Dr Sarah Jenkins. Address the letter to Dr Sarah Jenkins, City Medical Centre, 45 Orchard Lane, Newtown."

In your answer:

- Expand relevant notes into complete sentences
- Do not use note form
- Use letter format
- Body length: 180-200 words approx.